

ID.2 Permit Application Checklist

The code editions actually in force, the numbers Idaho set itself, the numbers your county sets, and the fees as the rules write them.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Idaho's Building Code Act does not put a private house under a building permit by itself — it authorizes each city and county to adopt and enforce a code, and where none has, there is no residential building permit, plan review, inspection or certificate of occupancy. The state Division of Occupational and Professional Licenses (DOPL) issues no building permit for a house. What does not depend on any of that: the electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits, which are statewide; the health-district septic permit; and the IDWR well drilling permit. The unit is the **jurisdiction** — a city inside a county routinely differs from the county around it. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Every fee here is a state rule figure or a figure printed on DOPL's own form, with its date. Local building-permit fees are not printed because each enforcing city and county sets its own — ask for the fee ordinance with the permit-process document.

THE CODE EDITIONS ACTUALLY IN FORCE

Two of these are set by statute and can only move by a bill. The rest are set by Board rule — and Idaho's rules face legislative review, which is how the last update died. See the box after the table.

What binds a house in Idaho, September 2026

Trade	Code and edition	Cite
Residential building	2018 International Residential Code, Parts I, II, III and IX , with Idaho amendments. Parts IV–VIII (energy, mechanical, fuel gas, plumbing, electrical) are excluded by statute and covered by the codes below. ICC sells it as the "2020 Idaho Residential Code" — same 2018 base	IDAPA 24.39.30.600.03; § 39-4109(1)(b)
Energy	2018 IECC with Idaho amendments, fixed by statute from 1 July 2022 and preempting every local government	§ 39-9701(1); IDAPA 24.39.30.600.06
Electrical	2023 National Electrical Code , "hereby adopted by the Idaho legislature" (effective 1 July 2023) — and amended downward by the Electrical Board. See the trap below	§ 54-1001; IDAPA 24.39.10.600

What binds a house in Idaho, September 2026

Trade	Code and edition	Cite
Plumbing	2015 Uniform Plumbing Code with Idaho amendments — DOPL calls it the "2017 Idaho State Plumbing Code (ISPC) based on the 2015 Uniform Plumbing Code." Not the IPC	IDAPA 24.39.20.600; § 54-2601
Mechanical, fuel gas	2018 International Mechanical Code, 2018 International Fuel Gas Code , and 2018 IRC Parts V and VI	IDAPA 24.39.70.600; § 54-5001
Fire sprinklers	Not required in one- and two-family dwellings — by statute, binding on every local government; R313.2 deleted from the Idaho code	§ 39-4116(3); IDAPA 24.39.30.600.03.j

How an edition changes. The IRC and IBC editions are whatever the Idaho Building Code Board adopts by rule; "any edition of the building codes adopted by the board will take effect on January 1 of the year following its adoption" (§ 39-4109(4)). The **energy** code edition is in the statute itself (§ 39-9701(1)), as is the **NEC** edition (§ 54-1001); only a bill moves either. And a ceiling on every residential amendment: none "shall be made by the Idaho building code board that provide for standards that are more restrictive than those published by the International Code Council" (§ 39-4109(3)). Every Idaho residential amendment loosens or clarifies; none tightens.

The 2024 update was rejected — and nothing is scheduled to replace it

DOPL proposed the 2024 I-Codes in Docket 24-3930-2502 (Idaho Administrative Bulletin, 1 October 2025, p. 358). On **17 February 2026** the House Business Committee's minutes record: "MOTION: Rep. Thompson made a motion to **reject Docket No. 24-3930-2502** due to the many concerns and questions regarding the proposed changes in addition to the incorporation by reference of the international code. Speaking to the motion, Rep. Crane (13) expressed his support of the motion, noting the need to create an Idaho Building Code." A substitute motion to hold the docket failed; the motion to reject "carried by voice vote."

DOPL's Building statutes-and-rules page, September 2026: "These boards are not currently engaged in rulemaking for 2026–2027. Existing rules remain in effect." So the **2018 IRC, IBC and IECC remain in force**, the rule paragraphs carry 7-1-24 dates, and no successor edition has a date. The committee's minuted questions — whole-house ventilation, sealing of registers, garage heat detectors, "blower door test frequency" — are a preview of the next fight. Confirm the edition printed on your permit.

THE ELECTRICAL TRAP — A 2023 NEC AMENDED DOWNWARD

A reader wiring to the national 2023 book will install AFCI on every circuit, a whole-house surge device and an outdoor emergency disconnect that Idaho does not require. A reader on a stale 2017 or 2020 book will miss Idaho's own island-receptacle rule. Either way, the table matters. All rows are IDAPA 24.39.10.600.01, effective 4 April 2025.

Idaho amendments to the 2023 NEC that change a house

Section	Idaho action	Effect
210.12(B) — AFCI	"Shall apply in full. Exception: In one- and two-family dwelling units, Arc-Fault Circuit-Interrupter Protection shall only apply to all branch circuits and outlets supplying bedrooms . All other locations in such units are exempt"	AFCI = bedrooms only
210.8(A) — GFCI, general	"Delete reference to 250-volt receptacles"; (5) replaced with "Unfinished areas of basements"; (7) food-prep areas deleted ; (8) sinks confined to areas other than kitchens; (11) laundry areas deleted . (6) Kitchens is <i>not</i> amended	Kitchen receptacles stay GFCI; laundry, wet bar, finished basement and 250-V do not
210.8(D), 422.5(A)(7) — appliances	In dwelling units, list items (7) dishwashers, (8) ranges, (9) wall ovens, (10) cooktops, (11) clothes dryers, (12) microwaves deleted	No appliance-specific GFCI
210.8(F) — outdoor outlets	List items (1) garages at or below grade and (2) accessory buildings deleted	Garage and outbuilding outdoor outlets drop out
215.18, 225.42, 230.67 — surge	For dwelling units a surge protection device "shall be permitted "; the requiring list item deleted	SPD not required
225.41, 230.85 — emergency disconnect	For one- and two-family dwellings "shall be permitted "; 230.85(C) deleted	Outdoor emergency disconnect not required
210.52(C) — islands	New item (4): island and peninsula receptacles, "if installed," may be mounted not more than 12 in below the countertop, not where the overhang exceeds 6 in	Island receptacles optional; below-counter allowed
210.52(E)(3) — decks	Balconies, decks and porches of 20 sq ft or more accessible from inside need one receptacle, not more than 6½ ft above the surface	Small decks exempt
314.27(C) — fan boxes	Second paragraph deleted	No fan-rated box required at every habitable-room ceiling outlet
334.15(C) — NM cable	May be secured to the bottom edge of joists in crawl spaces not over 4.5 ft high	Crawl-space wiring eased

*Rules of the Idaho Electrical Board, IDAPA 24.39.10, at adminrules.idaho.gov. Also in the same chapter: "No wiring or equipment may be concealed in any manner from access or sight until the work has been inspected and approved for cover by the electrical inspector" (500.01.a.i), and "all electrical permits shall be purchased before work is commenced" (500.01.a). Off-grid: rapid-shutdown relief for buildings 1,000 ft or more from utility lines and for detached PV-only structures (690.12 as amended); lead-acid battery systems need no ESS listing (706.5). **Where a city or county runs its own electrical program, the Idaho electrical code is still the standard by statute** (§ 54-1001B(1)(a)).*

THE ENERGY CODE — PINNED BY STATUTE, PREEMPTING EVERY COUNTY

"On and after July 1, 2022, the Idaho state energy code shall be the 2018 international energy conservation code, as amended ... by the Idaho building code board and approved by the legislature" (§ 39-9701(1)). And the preemption: "The provisions of this chapter **preempt, eliminate, and prohibit** any cities, counties ... or any other local governmental entities of any kind from adopting energy code or energy-related requirements ... that differ from or are more extensive than the requirements of the Idaho energy conservation code" (§ 39-9701(2)) — applying to local codes adopted "prior to, on, or after July 1, 2022" ((3)). **Nobody may add to this table.** Idaho deleted the model code's Zone 5 and Zone 6 rows and wrote its own:

Idaho Table R402.1.2 — insulation and fenestration by component (IDAPA 24.39.30.600.06.b)

Component	Climate Zone 5	Climate Zone 6
Fenestration U-factor	0.32	0.30
Skylight U-factor	0.55	0.55
Glazed fenestration SHGC	NR	NR
Ceiling	R-38	R-49
Wood-frame wall	R-20, or 13+5	R-22, or 13+5
Mass wall	13/17	15/20
Floor	R-30	R-30
Basement wall	15/19	15/19
Slab R-value and depth	R-10, 2 ft	R-10, 4 ft
Crawl-space wall	15/19	15/19

*Equivalent U-factors, Idaho Table R402.1.4 (600.06.d): Zone 5 ceiling 0.030, frame wall 0.060, floor 0.033; Zone 6 ceiling 0.026, frame wall 0.057. Every Idaho county is Zone 5 or Zone 6 under IECC Table R301.1 — look yours up in the model code, not in an Idaho amendment. Note the Zone 6 wall row: **R-22 or 13+5**, against the model code's 20+5 or 13+10 — a reduction, as the statute requires. Guides printing R-49 ceilings in Zone 5, R-38 floors, U-0.30 windows in Zone 5, or an "R-20+5" wall option are printing the model code, not Idaho's.*

No blower door unless you choose one — and one ventilation rule you cannot skip

Idaho adds an exception to R402.4.1.2: **"Visual Inspection.** The Permit Holder will determine **at the time of permit application** the method of determining building envelope tightness. A visual inspection shall be considered acceptable in lieu of testing when the items listed in Table R402.4.1.1, applicable to the method of construction, are field verified" (600.06.e). The choice is yours and it is made on the application. If you choose testing, the unamended 2018 figure of 3 air changes per hour at 50 pascals applies.

The other direction: Idaho replaced R303.4 so that "Dwelling units **shall be provided with whole-house mechanical ventilation** in accordance with Section M1505.4" (600.03.h) — mandatory, not tied to an air-leakage threshold. Design the ventilation system in; an exhaust fan on a timer is the usual minimum.

Log homes have their own Table R402.6 (600.06.f-g): an 8-inch minimum average log with R-49 ceiling and R-30 floor in both zones, or a 5-inch log with high-efficiency equipment. REScheck and R405 simulated performance remain available as alternatives.

WHAT THE COUNTY SETS — AND THE NUMBERS IDAHO WROTE ITSELF

The Act lets a local government amend, by ordinance, IRC "Section R301, Design Criteria" (§ 39-4116(4)(c)(iii)). That is the section that carries ground snow load, frost depth, wind speed, seismic design category, weathering and flood hazard. **No statewide value for any of them exists in the Act or in IDAPA 24.39.30** — a guide that prints a snow-load table by county is printing something no Idaho rule contains. Ask the building official for the adopted values, or for the site-specific study the ordinance requires, and write them here:

My jurisdiction's R301 design criteria, as told to me

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Ground snow load, and whether a site-specific study is required: psf _____ Study? _____ Who told me _____		
☐	Frost depth for footings: Inches _____ Who told me _____		

My jurisdiction's R301 design criteria, as told to me

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Seismic design category and ultimate design wind speed: SDC _____ Wind mph _____ Who told me _____		
☐	In a mapped flood hazard area? Yes / No _____ Source _____		

What Idaho did write into the residential code, uniform statewide unless your county has run the good-cause hearing:

Idaho's own numbers — IDAPA 24.39.30.600.03 unless noted

Subject	Idaho text	Cite
Footings	Idaho Table R403.1 replaces the model tables: 1-story light-frame footing width 12 in at every soil value; 2-story 15 in at 1,500 psf, 12 in from 2,000 psf up; spread footings at least 6 in thick	600.03.n-p
Garage separation	Table R302.6 replaced: 5/8-in Type X gypsum on the garage side for the residence, attics, habitable rooms above and the supporting structure	600.03.f
Floor membrane	R302.13 (fire protection of floors) deleted — no gypsum membrane under I-joists	600.03.g
Wall bracing	R602.10, or R602.12 where applicable, "or the most current edition of APA System Report SR-102 as an alternate method"	600.03.q
Windborne debris	R301.2.1.2 protection of openings — deleted	600.03.d
Permit exemptions	R105.2 kept, with pools exempt to 4 ft deep (not 24 in) and "11. Flag poles" added. Part I is locally amendable — confirm	600.03.b-c
Water service depth	The one statewide burial number: "The cover must be not less than forty-two (42) inches below grade" — a plumbing rule, not a frost depth	IDAPA 24.39.20.600.21
Softener loop	Every new one- or two-family residence "built slab on grade or that will have a finished basement at the time of final inspection must have a pre-plumbed water softener loop": one hot soft, one cold soft and one cold hard line at the kitchen sink; irrigation hose bibbs on hard water	IDAPA 24.39.20.600.26

Other plumbing amendments a house hits (IDAPA 24.39.20.600): underground drainage and vent piping at least 2 in (600.30); building sewer 4 in from the connection to inside the foundation (600.39); air admittance valves allowed only on island sinks in new residential construction, never in attics, crawl spaces or bathroom groups (600.46); sidewall venting expressly acceptable on cabins and log homes (600.44.a); no water-hammer arrestors required residentially (600.23). Mechanical (IDAPA 24.39.70.600.03): gas piping test at 20 psig for 20 minutes; dryer duct supported every 4 ft with no protruding fasteners.

THE TRADE PERMIT FEES, AS THE RULES SET THEM

These are DOPL's fees and apply wherever DOPL issues the permit. A city or county running its own program sets its own. Electrical and plumbing use the same ladder, measured on **living space** — which the plumbing worksheet defines to include an unfinished basement.

New one-family dwelling — electrical (IDAPA 24.39.10.500.02.a.i) and plumbing (IDAPA 24.39.20.500.02.a)

Living space	Electrical	Plumbing
Up to 1,500 sq ft of living space	\$130	\$130
1,501 to 2,500 sq ft	\$195	\$195
2,501 to 3,500 sq ft	\$260	\$260
3,501 to 4,500 sq ft	\$325	\$325
Over 4,500 sq ft	\$325 + \$65 per additional 1,000 sq ft or part	\$325 + \$65 per additional 1,000 sq ft or part
Includes	"associated buildings with wiring being constructed on each property"	"all buildings with plumbing systems being constructed on each property"

Residential HVAC (IDAPA 24.39.70.500.02.a; DOPL Homeowner HVAC fee schedule rev. 8/17/2022)

Item	Fee
Base permit	\$100
Furnace, heat pump, air conditioner, boiler, mini-split, free-standing solid-fuel stove, gas fireplace or similar appliance, including its ducts, vents and flues	\$30 first, \$15 each additional
Exhaust or ventilation duct — dryer, range hood, bath fan and similar	\$15 first, \$5 each additional
Fuel gas piping	\$5 per appliance outlet
Hydronic system	\$5 per zone

Residential HVAC (IDAPA 24.39.70.500.02.a; DOPL Homeowner HVAC fee schedule rev. 8/17/2022)

Item	Fee
Manual S, J and D review — "required when installing the primary heating and/or cooling system in a NEW single or two-family dwelling"	\$25 — on the DOPL homeowner form, not in the rule table

A worked example, so the arithmetic is not a surprise

A **2,200 sq ft** house with a gas furnace and an air conditioner, four exhaust ducts (dryer, range hood, two bath fans) and three gas outlets. Electrical **\$195**. Plumbing **\$195**. HVAC: \$100 base + \$30 furnace + \$15 A/C + \$15 first duct + \$15 for three more + \$15 gas outlets + \$25 Manual J/S/D review = **\$215**. **\$605 in state trade permits** — with the electrical one including the shop, and the plumbing one including every building with plumbing on the lot. Bring the load, equipment-selection and duct calculations to the HVAC permit; the review line is on the form.

Around the fees. Every trade permit expires **365 days** from purchase (plumbing and HVAC: or last inspection); renewal for one year is \$65 (24.39.10.500.01.c; 24.39.20.500.01.c; 24.39.70.500.01.c). Reinspection for work not ready, bad directions or an uncorrected notice: \$65 (24.39.10.500.04). Plan check: \$65 per hour (24.39.10.500.06). An extra \$65 "may be assessed if the location is not clearly given" — the forms say so. HVAC without a permit: **double fee**, triple on a repeat within 12 months (§ 54-5017(4)). DOPL's FAQ: an Enforcement Permit for work done without one costs "double the original amount."

THE BUILDING PERMIT FEE — LOCAL, AND WHY DOPL'S TABLE IS NOT YOURS

DOPL publishes a building fee table — Table 1-A in IDAPA 24.39.30.500.03, \$695.63 for the first \$100,000 of valuation plus \$3.92 per additional \$1,000, with plan review at \$100 per hour between 40% and 65% of the permit fee. **It applies only to permits DOPL issues** — state buildings, public schools, modular units. It is not a default for a house, because there is no default: where a county has adopted a building code its fee ordinance governs, and where it has not there is no building permit and no fee. Ask for the fee ordinance together with the § 39-4117(1) permit-process document, and write the answer on the record at the end of this document.

THE SEPTIC PACKAGE, IN ORDER

DEQ writes the rules (IDAPA 58.01.03, rewritten effective 1 July 2025); Idaho's seven public health districts issue the permits and do the inspections under a memorandum of understanding with DEQ. The permit constrains where the house can sit, so it comes before the footprint is fixed.

IDAPA 58.01.03 — the sequence

	Step	What the rule says
1	Site evaluation	A standard drainfield site "will not exceed twenty percent (20%)" slope (008.01.a); "an acceptable site must be large enough to construct two (2) complete drainfields ," each sized for 100% of the design flow (008.02.c). Test-hole inspections need 48 hours' notice, weekends and holidays excluded (011.03)
2	Installation permit	"No person may ... install any individual or subsurface sewage disposal system ... unless there is a valid installation permit" (005.01). Valid two years from issue unless the permit says otherwise (005.08)
3	Who installs	A registered installer — except " owners installing their own standard or basic alternative system " as described in the TGM" need no installer's permit (006.08.b). Complex systems need a registered complex installer
4	Final and as-built	" No system may receive wastewater until the Director conducts a final installation inspection and completes as-built drawings"; you get the as-built within 30 days (011.05)

Fees (IDAPA 58.01.14.110, minimums — "designees may adopt different fees" and must publish them online): basic or complex system permit **\$400**; tank only \$300; renewal \$40. **Sizing** (58.01.03.007.09, .007.08.a, .008.02.b): design flow 250 gpd for a 3-bedroom house, ± 50 gpd per bedroom; minimum tank **1,000 gallons**, +250 per bedroom over four; absorption area = flow $\div$ 1.0 / 0.5 / 0.2 gal per sq ft per day for soil groups A / B / C. A 3-bedroom house on group B soil: 500 sq ft of trench bottom, twice over for the reserve area.

Separation distances — statewide minimums the health district may increase

Between	Minimum	IDAPA 58.01.03 unless noted
Drainfield to a well or other domestic supply	100 ft	008.01.d
Drainfield to permanent surface water, soil A / B / C	200 / 125 / 100 ft	008.01.d
Drainfield to a basement foundation; to crawl space or slab	20 ft ; 10 ft	008.01.d
Drainfield or tank to the property line	5 ft	008.01.d; 007.18
Septic tank to a private well	50 ft	007.18
Septic tank to a dwelling or building	5 ft	007.18
Well to any permanent building; to the property line	10 ft; 5 ft	IDAPA 37.03.09.025.01.d

IF YOU ARE ON A WELL

The well sequence

	What the statute and rule require
You may not drill it yourself	"It shall be unlawful for any person to drill a well in Idaho ... without first complying with the provisions of this chapter," and "person" means "any individual who drills or abandons any well for himself or another" (§ 42-238(2), (3)). IDWR: "All wells must be constructed by a well driller with a valid license from IDWR"
Drilling permit before drilling	"Prior to beginning construction of any well ... the driller or well owner shall obtain a permit" — \$75 for a domestic well (§ 42-235). IDWR's rules provide a "Start Card" — "an expedited drilling permit process for the construction of cold water, single-family residential wells" (IDAPA 37.03.09.010.49)
No water right needed — usually	A domestic well — up to 13,000 gallons per day including irrigation of up to half an acre (§ 42-111(1)) — needs no water-right permit (§ 42-227(1)). Except in a subdivision whose application was filed on or after 1 July 2025 inside a moratorium, critical ground water or ground water management area: there a permit is required for anything beyond in-home use and livestock (§ 42-227(4))
Driller's report, after	Filed with IDWR "within thirty (30) days following the completion of the well" (§ 42-238(11)). Get a copy — it is the well's only record, and IDWR's well-log search holds it
Siting and casing	Casing at least 12 in above finished grade (IDAPA 37.03.09.025.04); afterwards "the well owner must not construct or allow construction of any permanent building, except for buildings to house a well or plumbing apparatus ... closer than ten (10) feet " (036.03)

PERMIT RECORD — FILL THIS IN AS EACH ONE ISSUES

Every approval on this build

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Septic installation permit from health district No. ___, or written confirmation of public sewer: Number _____ Issued _____ Expires _____		
☐	Septic final inspection passed and as-built received: Date _____ As-built received _____		

Every approval on this build

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	IDWR drilling permit and the driller's license number: Permit _____ Driller license _____		
☐	Well driller's report received — due within 30 days: Date _____ Well tag / log no. _____		
☐	Building permit , if one exists where I am building, the code edition printed on it, and the certificate of occupancy at the end: Number _____ Edition _____ Expires _____ CO no. _____		
☐	Electrical and plumbing permits — DOPL or local: Elec. no. _____ Issued _____ Plb. no. _____ Issued _____		
☐	HVAC permit — and Manual J/S/D submitted: Number _____ Issued _____ J/S/D in? _____		
☐	Envelope method chosen on the application — visual inspection or blower-door test: Method _____		
☐	Zoning approval, floodplain determination and 911 address — all local, all independent of the building code: Zoning ref. _____ Flood: in / out _____ Address _____		

Everything cited here is free to read. Statutes are at legislature.idaho.gov → Idaho Statutes, one section per page (.../idstat/Title54/T54CH10/SECT54-1016/), each ending with a History line naming every session law that amended it. Rules are at adminrules.idaho.gov, one PDF per IDAPA chapter (.../rules/current/24/243910.pdf), every paragraph carrying its own effective date. **One warning:** DOPL is not your building department — its own form says so. Read September 2026.